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Gangotri

Gangotri is a town and a *Nagar Panchayat* (municipality) in Uttarkashi district in the state of Uttarakhand, India. It is 99 km from Uttarkashi, the main district headquarter. It is a Hindu pilgrim town on the banks of the river Bhagirathi – the origin of the river Ganges. The town is located on the Greater Himalayan Range, at a height of 3,100 metres (10,200 ft). According to a popular Hindu legend, the goddess Ganga descended here when Shiva released the mighty river from the locks of his hair.

Gangotri

Town

Gangotri

Interactive map of Gangotri

Location in Uttarakhand, India

Significance

Ganga River

Gangotri is one of the four sites in the Chota Char Dham pilgrimage circuit. It is also the origin of the Ganges River and, per Hinduism, the seat of the goddess Ganga. The source of the Ganges River is the Bhagirathi River, originating from the Gangotri Glacier.[1] Once the river confluences with the Alakananda River at a town called Devprayag it finally acquires the name *Ganga*.[2]

Near the river is a stone where King Bhagiratha performed penance to Shiva in order to bring the Ganga down to earth and absolve the sins of his ancestors.[3] According to another legend, Pandavas performed the great 'Deva Yajna' here to atone the deaths of their kinsmen in the epic battle of the Mahabharata**.** Hindus believe that performing the ancestral rites on the banks of Bhagirathi frees the spirit of the ancestor from the cycle of rebirth and a holy dip in its waters cleanses sins committed in the present also past births.[4]

Gangotri Temple

The original Gangotri Temple was built by the Nepalese general Amar Singh Thapa and later restored in the 19th century.[3] The temple is closed from Diwali day every year and is reopened on Akshaya Tritiya.[5] During this time, the idol of the goddess is kept at Mukhba village, near Harsil. Ritual duties of the temple are supervised by the Semwal family of pujaris. These pujaris hail from Mukhba village.

Gangotri
(India)
Coordinates: 30.994°N 78.941°E

Country	India
State	Uttarakhand
District	Uttarkashi
Elevation	3,415 m (11,204 ft)
Population (2001)	
• **Total**	606
Languages	
• **Official**	Hindi
Time zone	UTC+5:30 (IST)
Vehicle registration	UK
Website	badrinath-kedarnath.gov.in (https://badrinath-kedarnath.gov.in/)

Demographics

According to the 2011 census of India, there are total 47 families residing in Gangotri. The total population of Gangotri is 110 out of which 97 are males and 13 are females. The literacy rate of Gangotri is 99.1%. The entire population of Gangotri identifies as Hindu.[6]

See also

- Gangotri National Park
- Harsil
- Yamuna
- Akshaya Tritiya
- Mukhba

Chota Char Dham

Yamunotri

Gangotri

Kedarnath

Badrinath

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Bhagirathi River and Himalayas in Gangotri, Uttarakhand

6. "Census: Population: Uttarakhand: Gangotri | Economic Indicators | CEIC" (https://www.ceicdata.com/en/india/census-population-by-towns-and-urban-agglomerations-uttarakhand/census-population-uttarakhand-gangotri). *ceicdata.com*. Retrieved 14 May 2022.

External links

- Official website (https://badrinath-kedarnath.gov.in/)
- Media related to Gangotri at Wikimedia Commons
- Gangotri travel guide from Wikivoyage

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